

Amanda (Ward) Urbizo-Haukjaer

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EDUCATION

Ph.D., *University of Illinois Chicago (UIC)* | 2020 – 2026

- Community and Applied Developmental Psychology
- Quantitative Statistics, Minor
- *University Access to Excellence Fellowship*: A four-year academic scholarship with the goal of increasing the number of students from historically underrepresented groups in graduate education who enter careers as researchers and college faculty.
- Dissertation: *Policy, Power, and Sexual Violence: Critically Analyzing the Impact of Sexual Assault Kit Handling Laws*

M.A., *University of Cincinnati (UC)* | 2018 – 2020

- Community Psychology
- Graduate Certificates: Women, Gender, and Sexuality Studies; Applied Behavioral Analysis
- Thesis: *Ideology and Rape Culture: Examining the Influence of Neoliberalism on Rape Myths*

Honors B.S., *University of Georgia (UGA)* | 2014 – 2017

- Psychology, Major
- Statistics, Minor
- Magna Cum Laude
- *Georgia's Zell Miller Scholarship*: A four-year academic scholarship that covers full in-state tuition. Recipients must maintain a consistent overall GPA of 3.3 or higher.
- *Dean's List*: Received a GPA of 3.7 or higher at the end of the semester. Five-time consecutive recipient.

Study Abroad, *St. John's University, Paris Campus* | Summer 2016

- Classes: Sociology of Tourism, Sociology of Global Terrorism

STATISTICAL & TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Advanced training in regression, structural equation modeling, mixed-effects modeling, sampling methods, nonparametric analysis, and data science applications.
- Expertise in R SPSS, JASP, and JAMOVI; working knowledge of NVivo, SQL, Tableau, and Power BI.
- Skilled in REDCap for database design and data management.
- Proficient in Canva, Procreate, and Affinity Publisher for graphic design, including report layout, infographic creation, data visualization, and research dissemination materials.
- Highly proficient in Microsoft Office Suite.
- Working proficiency in Spanish.

PRINCIPAL RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Principal Investigator, *Policy, Power, and Sexual Violence: A Critical Analysis of Sexual Assault Kit Submission Laws and Their Impact.* | 2024 - 2026

Department of Psychology, UIC, doctoral dissertation conducted under Dr. Jessica Shaw. Research applies advanced quantitative methods to assess the effects of state-level sexual assault kit (SAK) submission policies on system outcomes from 2000-2019 across the U.S.

- *Study 1: Did it Work in Illinois? Evaluating the Impact of the First Sexual Assault Evidence Submission Act on Reporting and Arrests*
 - Utilized Illinois Uniform Crime Reporting (I-UCR) data aggregated across five regions and applied mixed-effects interrupted time series models to evaluate whether Illinois' 2010 Sexual Assault Evidence Submission Act was associated with changes in sexual assault reporting and arrest rates.
- *Study 2: From Mishandling Evidence to Unchanged Case Outcomes: Sexual Assault Kit Submission Laws and Attrition Across the U.S.*
 - Combined Uniform Crime Reporting (UCR), National Incident-Based Reporting System (NIBRS), and U.S. Census data and applied mixed-effects models to compare reporting, arrest, and exceptional clearance rates between states with and without sexual assault kit submission laws and conducted staggered regression discontinuity and grouped binomial models to estimate changes in outcomes following law enactment among law states.
- *Study 3: Beyond Adoption: How the Structure of Sexual Assault Kit Submission Laws Shapes Reporting and Arrest Outcomes*
 - Created an original dataset coding state SAK submission laws and integrated UCR and NIBRS data and applied mixed-effects dose-response interrupted time series models to examine whether greater law comprehensiveness and shorter submission timelines were associated with higher sexual assault reporting and arrest rates.

Principle Investigator, *Centering Latinx Survivors: A Critical Examination of Sexual Assault Dynamics Among Latinx Survivors Who Sought Medical Care* | 2021-2024

Department of Psychology, UIC, research conducted under Dr. Jessica Shaw.

Research examined racialized dynamics of sexual assault using medical forensic exam data.

- Analyzed a statewide dataset of SAK medical records spanning five years (N = 2,860), to document pattern among survivors racialized as Latinx and compare to them to their white counterparts.
- Conducted descriptive statistics, chi-square tests, and logistic regression to identify differences in multiple case characteristics including perpetrator relationship, assault characteristics, and reporting outcomes.

Evaluation Consultant, *Illinois Coalition Against Sexual Assault (ICASA) Telehealth Platform Evaluation* | 2021-2022

ICASA is a not-for-profit corporation of 31 community-based sexual assault crisis centers working together to end sexual violence. Research evaluated the use and feedback of their telehealth platform used by rape crisis centers across Illinois.

- Developed and administered evaluation survey; Coded and analyzed quantitative data and used R to analyze qualitative survey data; delivered data-driven insights and action steps at quarterly stakeholder meeting.

Principle Investigator, *Ideology and Rape Culture: Examining the Influence of Neoliberalism on Rape Myths* | 2019-2020

Department of Psychology, UC, master's thesis conducted under Dr. Anjali Dutt.

Research investigated the relationship between neoliberal ideology, sexism, and rape myth acceptance using an experimental approach.

- Designed and implemented an experimental study using randomized priming (neoliberalism vs. liberatory ethics of care vs. control) with a national sample recruited via Prolific (N = 166) utilizing vignettes, surveys, and validated measures.
- Conducted ANOVAs, ANCOVAs, correlation, and regression analyses to test causal and correlational relationships among ideology, sexism, and rape myth acceptance; Identified demographic predictors (gender, religiosity, political ideology, feminist identification) that accounted for variance in rape myth acceptance, neoliberal endorsement, and sexism.

Program Development Consultant, *Cradle Cincinnati – Queen's Village New Mother Workforce Development Program* | 2019

Community-based organization focused on shifting racial disparities in birth outcomes and the conditions that drive inequity in maternal and infant health. Research used community-based participatory research to gather input on what a new workforce development program.

- Conducted focus groups; Coded and analyzed quantitative data using multiple regression and used Excel to analyze qualitative survey data; presented analysis report and recommendations with stakeholders.

RESEARCH ASSISTANTSHIPS AND PROJECTS

Graduate Research Assistant, *Student Affairs Assessment & Planning* | 2025 – Present

UIC Student Affairs Assessment & Planning, research conducted under Dr. Sue Farruggia.

Research goals are to partner with units across Student Affairs to enhance their work through data-informed decision-making, strategic planning, and research.

- “*Understanding the Needs of Transfer Students*”; Funded by Bridges to Brighter Future, a collaboration between Kinship Foundation and The Chicago Community Trust.
 - Edited and proofed six research reports and created an executive summary; Designed and maintained project website.
- “*Strategies and Well-Being Among Financially Stressed College Students at a Four-Year University*”
 - Contributed to writing manuscript and ROI report.
- Created infographics, annual reports, and dissemination documents; Facilitated workshops and program reviews with SA units; Maintained the Assessment & Planning website; Collaborated with multiple SA units and cross-campus partners managing several concurrent projects.

Research Associate, *Gender Justice Initiative* | 2020 – 2025

Department of Psychology, UIC, research conducted under Dr. Jessica Shaw.

Research goals are to use research and evaluation to improve systems that respond to and interface with those affected by gender-based violence.

- “*Examining the SANE and TeleSANE Patient Experience: An Evaluation and Tool Development*”; Funded by the U.S. Department of Justice, Office on Violence Against Women (\$449, 979)
 - Drafted IRB application and conducted literature reviews; Created data collection tool in REDcap; Recruited and administered surveys and interviews with sexual assault survivors; Transcribed surveys and interviews; Analyzed quantitative and qualitative data; Supervised RAs in transcript cleaning; Led weekly RA meetings.
- “*Evaluation of a Cross-System Cooperative Response to Adolescent Sexual Assault*”; Funded by the U.S. Department of Justice, Office on Violence Against Women (\$313,559)
 - Coded and analyzed qualitative transcripts of sexual assault survivor interviews.
- “*The Work Experiences and Needs of Lone Community Psychologists: Exploring Diversity of Settings and Identities*”
 - Cleaned and analyzed interview transcripts.

Graduate Research Assistant, *Human Rights and Social Context* | 2018 – 2020

Department of Psychology, UC, research conducted under Dr. Anjali Dutt.

Research goals are to examine the role of care, neoliberal ideology, and moral inclusion on human rights for immigrants, refugees, and Central American asylum seekers.

- “*Uniting Liberatory and Participatory Approaches in Public Psychology with Refugees*”; Funded by AmeriCorps, Office of Research and Evaluation (\$99,730)
 - Managed data and conducted statistical analysis in R to continuation of grant; supervised undergraduate assistant by delegating tasks, teaching software, and checking data entry.
- “*Assessing the Relationship between Neoliberal Ideology and Reactions to Central American Asylum Seekers in the United States*”
 - Finalized survey; wrote interview protocol; coded interview data.

Graduate Research Assistant, *Center for Organizational Leadership* | 2017 – 2020

Department of Psychology, UC, research conducted under Dr. Donna Chrobot-Mason.

Research goals are to examine the role of leadership development in spanning boundaries, diversifying, and promoting inclusion and collaboration while maintaining organizational effectiveness.

- “*Faculty Diversity Training Program*”
 - Planned research design phases; conducted literature reviews; drafted IRB proposal; developed facilitator toolkit and information kit.
- “*Diversity in the Office of Research*”
 - Completed data entry into Qualtrics; ran statistical analysis in R.
- “*Virtual Reality Leadership Training*”
 - Designed research phases; synthesized literature; developed study on virtual reality applications.

Undergraduate Research Assistant, *Cultural Evolution & Optimal Experience* | 2016 – 2017

Department of Psychology, UGA, research conducted under Dr. Leonard Martin.

Research goals are to test social sensitivity, assess participant's specific feelings about future goals, and find correlations between meaning of life and life satisfaction.

- “*Psychology of Police Brutality*”, Project Lead
 - Greeted and debriefed lab participants before and after study participation; administered surveys to evaluate psychological influences on perceptions of police shootings; collected data and conducted correlational analyses.
- “*Facial Feedback Hypothesis*”
 - Planned study replication and refining methodological design; managed lab set-up and maintained research materials; collected and analyzed data using SPSS.
- “*Job Preferences*”
 - Administered surveys to assess participants' attitudes toward job preferences; cleaned data in excel; coordinated research schedules and mentored new researchers.

PUBLICATIONS, REPORTS, & REVIEWER EXPERIENCE

Publications

- **Urbizo-Haukjaer, A.**, Benitez Cruz, C.A., & Shaw, J. (2025). Centering Latinx survivors: A critical examination of sexual assault dynamics among latinx survivors who sought medical care. *Violence Against Women*. Advanced online publication.
- Raja, S., Peña, V., Farruggia, S. P., **Urbizo-Haukjaer, A.** (Under Review). Strategies and Well-Being Among Financially Stressed College Students at a Four-Year University. Submitted to *Journal of American College Health*.
- Farruggia, S.P., Peña, V., Wilson, D.J., **Urbizo-Haukjaer, A.** (Under Review). Promoting Academic Success and Retention Through a Financial Wellness Program. Submitted to *Journal of College Student Retention*.
- **Urbizo-Haukjaer, A.**, Shaw, J., Estabrook, R. (In Preparation). Did it work in illinois? Evaluating the impact of the first sexual assault evidence submission act on reporting and arrests. Will be submitted to *Violence Against Women*.
- **Urbizo-Haukjaer, A.**, Shaw, J., Estabrook, R. (In Preparation). From mishandling evidence to unchanged case outcomes: Sexual assault kit submission laws and attrition across the U.S. Will be submitted to *Law and Human Behavior*.
- **Urbizo-Haukjaer, A.**, Shaw, J., Estabrook, R. (In Preparation). Beyond adoption: How the structure of sexual assault kit submission laws shapes reporting and arrest outcomes. Will be submitted to *Criminology and Public Policy*.
- Shaw, J., Bailey, C.; Danylkiv, A., Harris, A., **Urbizo-Haukjaer, A.**, Greeson, M. (In Preparation). “I don’t often hear my story getting told”: Sexual assault survivors’ motivations, hesitations, and reflections on participating in research.

Reports

- Farruggia, S.P., Wilson, D.J., **Urbizo-Haukjaer, A.**, Pasillas-Santoyo, A. & Enciso, G. (December, 2025). *The Fall Survey 2025: Graduate Student Information*. UIC Student Affairs Assessment and Planning. Chicago, IL.
- Farruggia, S.P., Wilson, D.J., **Urbizo-Haukjaer, A.**, Pasillas-Santoyo, A. & Enciso, G. (December, 2025). *The Fall Survey 2025: Professional Student Information*. UIC Student Affairs Assessment and Planning. Chicago, IL.
- Farruggia, S.P., Wilson, D.J., **Urbizo-Haukjaer, A.**, Pasillas-Santoyo, A. & Enciso, G. (December, 2025). *The Fall Survey 2025: Undergraduate Student Information*. UIC Student Affairs Assessment and Planning. Chicago, IL.

Reviewer Experience

- **Reviewer**, *American Psychological Association Division 27 Conference*, 2025
- **Ad Hoc Reviewer**, *American Journal for Community Psychology*, 2024

RESEARCH PRESENTATIONS

Urbizo-Haukjaer, A., Benitez Cruz, C., Shaw, J., (2025, June). Centering Latinx Survivors: A Critical Examination of Sexual Assault Dynamics among Latinx Survivors who Sought Medical Care, Poster Submitted to Society for Community Research and Action Biennial Conference 2025, East Lansing, MI.

Gelsinger, A; Bailey, C; **Urbizo-Haukjaer, A**; Shaw, J. (2025, June). *"We are contacting you because you were recently at the hospital": A workshop on recruiting "hidden" or "hard-to-reach" participants at the point of receiving care*, A Workshop Submitted to Society for Community Research and Action Biennial Conference 2025, East Lansing, MI.

Shaw, J., Bailey, C.; Danylkiv, A., **Urbizo-Haukjaer, A.**, Greeson, M., (2023, June). *To whom are we responsible? Critically examining who is centered in our work, how, and why*. Symposium presented at the Society for Research and Action Biennial Conference 2023, Atlanta, GA.

Bailey, C., Benitez Cruz, C., Thursby, K., Areguy, F., **Urbizo-Haukjaer, A.**, Ramos; S., (2023, June). *It's what, where, and how you do it: A townhall on community psychology training, and practice beyond the academy*. Town hall presented at the Society for Research and Action Biennial Conference 2023, Atlanta, GA.

Shaw, J., Sevilla, R., **Urbizo-Haukjaer, A.**, Thursby, K., (2022, August). *Designing and Implementing a Psychology Doctoral Training Course on Research and Reflexivity*. Roundtable presented at the American Psychological Association Convention 2022, Minneapolis, MN.

Vason, T., **Ward, A.**, Mason, L., Moore, D., Chrobot-Mason, D., (2020, April). *Learning to Create Inclusivity Through Interactive Engagement*. Group Workshop presented at the 11th Annual Equity and Inclusion Conference at the University of Cincinnati.¹

¹ Canceled due to COVID-19.

- Dutt, A., Chaudhary, N., Kirkendall, S., **Ward, A.**, (2020, March). *The Role of Social Context in Actualizing Women's Rights and Women's Agency*. Symposium presented at the annual Association for Women in Psychology Conference in Austin, Texas.
- Ward, A.**, and Dutt, A., (2019, October). *Neoliberal Ideology and Rape Culture*. Poster presented at the Midwestern Region of the Society for Community Research and Action ECO Conference at the National Louis University, Lisle Campus.
- Vason, T., **Ward, A.**, Mason, L., Black, S., Moore, D., Chrobot-Mason, D., (2019, March). *Using Critical Incidents to Foster Inclusion at UC*. PowerPoint presented at Uptown Campus for the Equity and Inclusion Office at the University of Cincinnati.
- Kessler, A., **Ward, A.**, Brandt, C., Smith, M., Moore, D., Chrobot-Mason, D., (2018, April). *Using Critical Incidents to Foster Inclusion at UC*. PowerPoint presented at the 10th Annual Equity and Inclusion Conference at the University of Cincinnati.
- Ward, A.**, Brandt, C., Fraser, T., Chrobot-Mason, D., (2018, April). *Students' Experience with Microaggressions in Higher Education*. Poster presented at the Undergraduate Scholarly Showcase at the University of Cincinnati.
- Ward, A.**, and Martin, L., (2017, April). *Psychology of Police Brutality*. Poster presented at the 40th Annual Psi Chi Convention at the University of Georgia.

TEACHER'S ASSISTANT EXPERIENCE

Statistical Methods in Behavioral Sciences, *UIC* | F 2021; F 2022 – S 2023; F 2024

- Led weekly discussion sections on introductory hypothesis testing and statistical measures; Evaluated and graded homework and exams, providing detailed feedback to enhance student understanding.

Advanced Statistics, *UIC* | S 2022; S 2024

- Led weekly discussion sections on advanced hypothesis testing and regression using SPSS; Evaluated and graded homework and exams, providing detailed feedback to enhance student understanding.

Community Psychology, *UIC* | F 2023

- Assisted instructor during weekly lectures; Evaluated and graded term papers, providing constructive feedback.

Resilience: The Science of Positive Adaptation, *UIC* | F 2023

- Assessed discussion board activities, book reports, and final papers; Provided detailed feedback to support student learning.

Introduction to Psychology, *UIC* | F 2020 – S 2021

- Led weekly discussion sections on various psychology topics; Graded homework, quizzes, and papers; Mentored students to support their academic development.

Women and Activism, *UC* | S 2019; S 2020

- Designed and delivered lectures; Evaluated exams and provided detailed feedback; Managed two undergraduate teaching assistants.

Organizational Behavior for Effective Leaders, UC | S 2020

- Created and presented lectures; Assessed assignments and provided constructive feedback to students.

Capstone Course, UC | S 2019.

- Co-led classroom instruction with other TAs; Advised four students, providing one-on-one mentorship and feedback; Graded all assignments for a senior organizational leadership capstone class.

Grad Statistics I, UC | F 2018

- Designed and delivered guest lectures for a graduate-level statistics course; Evaluated exams, provided corrections, and offered tutoring support for statistical concepts and JASP use in and out of class.

Diversity in the Workplace, UC | S 2018

- Developed and presented lectures; Evaluated exams and papers, offering detailed feedback to students.

COMMUNITY LEADERSHIP

Psychology Undergrad Research Readiness (PURR) Program Student Mentor, UIC | 2023

- Facilitated bi-monthly meetings with two undergraduate mentees towards an overall program goal of equipping undergraduate psychology and allied majors with research knowledge, skills, and mentorship to strengthen their academic and research portfolios and join a supportive community.
- Guided undergraduate students in research skill development, graduate school preparation, and professional growth.

Psi Chi Social Committee Head, UGA | 2016 – 2017

- Organized social and philanthropic events, fostering community engagement among psychology students.

Note Taker, UGA | 2016 – 2017

- Wrote and distributed class notes in collaboration with the Disability Center for the Research Analysis and Social Psychology undergraduate courses.

Psi Chi Student Member, UGA | 2015 – 2017

- Co-hosted the 39th and 40th Annual Psi Chi Convention.
- Volunteered for projects and events that resulted in positive outcomes for the community including Athens Humane Society, Project Safe, Food Bank, ESP Fall Festival, and Thomas Lay Tutoring.

Creswell Dormitory Community Council Representative, UGA | 2014 – 2015

- Advocated for residents by representing two floors in monthly meetings; Facilitated communication between council and students to address concerns and initiatives.

WORK EXPERIENCE AND TRAINING

Graduate Assistant, *UC Office of Nationally Competitive Awards* | 2018 – 2020

- Advised undergraduate students, graduate students, and alumni to identify and apply for prestigious competitive awards.
- Worked directly with applicants to draft their application essays and to provide feedback.
- Faculties workshops on scholarships and fellowship for audiences of both university faculty, staff, undergraduate, and graduate students.

Outdoor Adventure Leader, *Camp Twin Lakes* | 2017

- Guided and motivated special populations with Celiac Disease, physical disabilities, Autism Spectrum Disorder, and with foster children and military families.
- Created and implemented alternative curricula to meet specific needs and issues of campers.
- Trained volunteers, junior counselors, and campers to lead groups and build community.

40-hour Sexual Assault Crisis Intervention & Medical Advocacy Training, *YWCA* | 2021

- Completed Illinois state-recognized certification in Basic Crisis Intervention Skills, including training on crisis hotline and emergency room response for sexual assault cases.
- Developed a comprehensive understanding of sexual violence, rape culture, and trauma-informed response techniques.